

well. For most people, there is no getting away from the big F!

Life happens on Facebook, literally:

A lot of us cannot remember birthdays. Facebook is the saviour. Log in via the web browser and there is the list of people who need to be wished! If your FB calendar is synced on the phone, an alarm/popup display will save you from a torrent of abuses at a later date (or in some cases, later during the same day)! Events are planned on the mecca of social networking and invitations are sent on FB itself. The latest trend is to distribute wedding invitations via FB. For this to work seamlessly, it is expected that you will be accessing FB rather regularly, even if not via some constantly updating app. If not, you run the risk of becoming a social pariah. And in the present scenario, that may be the point of no return.

Source of information, and lots of irrelevant info: Status updates are not always about what someone is eating or drinking or which movie sucks. Sometimes, some people actually post relevant, important and knowledgeable stuff. News updates, cricket and football match updates and even some interesting articles can find their way on your Facebook update page – all thanks to your friends. The human angle – personal, emotional



and professional is what decides the content of the posts.

The human angle ensures emotions spill on to the social networks, and you will see posts like “Please

stop ruining my week-ends.....”, “disastrous start of the day...aar-rghhh!” and “Wish you all a happy chocolate day... got 2 Bournville and 1 dairy milk yippee !!!!!”. And without a shadow of a doubt, most of us do it too, at some point of time.

Quora: the different social network

Most social networks start with the basis of ‘making friends’ first and the spread of info and sharing of ideas is a secondary feature. However, with Quora, things are a bit different. The idea behind www.quora.com is to build a knowledge sharing platform, where users can ask questions, get answers from members of the community and follow not only people but also topics for discussion. Since this is a targeted setup, the chances of you getting a lot more relevant stuff to see each time you log in are a lot more. Unfortunately, Signing up for is a bit tricky at the moment, since it requires you to have an invite.

It sucks: Why you need to stay away

- Overwhelming: Social networking has become too “in your face”, thanks to it being a constant companion. No matter where you are, or what you are doing, the PC, laptop, mobile and even the likes of an HD media player (WD Live etc.) will bring you the latest updates. Staying connected is good, but the moment the online world starts taking over the offline world, then you must realize there is a problem which needs a solution.
- Lack of judgement: Some people really have no clue what they are posting on the www. Twitter and

IMAGINE A WORLD BEYOND FB

- Friends will actually talk to each other. And not just depend on status updates and wall posts.
- When someone sends you a friend request, instead of feeling proud about another number added to the list, you will actually try to get to know the other person. Particularly if it's in a nightclub!
- You cannot walk out of your home and start shooting at people. Life is not the Mafia Wars game.
- When you will see something interesting, you may share it with the people around you. And not search for the “Like” button.
- When you drive outside the city, you will see real farms, and actual farming activity. Not the one on the computer screen in an app called Farmville.
- Full length sentences and conversations will come back into fashion. Character limits don't apply in real life.
- You will actually get photos from the party last weekend- either on Picasa or via email or even in a USB drive. There is no Tag in real life.
- Poking someone you know may still place you at the receiving end of a tight slap. Poking someone you don't know may get you in a police station lock-up or facing a sexual harassment lawsuit.
- Wedding invitations will be sent the traditional way- wedding invitation cards!
- Peer Pressure Groups will shift focus back to things like drinks and drugs, from the “make a Facebook profile” phase.

Facebook timelines, for example, are usually flooded with a lot of random thoughts. And they get personal and abusive at times. Some also end up revealing personal information about them. Don't walk down that road!

● Waste of Time: Games like Farmville and Mafia Wars have become extremely popular and are considered as excellent stress-busters. But the fact that they are so addictive means that even though the stress may have disappeared, people end up playing these games much longer than they had bargained for. Hours spent in office are wasted in huge quantities, and the bosses are not pleased! 

A PARALLEL UNIVERSE!

- Facebook is possibly the only place where you won't get arrested for poking that cute looking girl!
- Facebook has given birth to a new breed of farmers... without the dirt, grime and smells...truly new age!
- Stalking someone online may not get you in as much trouble as if you are found standing in the back alley of the person's home, trying to sneak a peek in through the window!
- Quantity, not quality matters. The more friends you have, the better your chances of bragging about your popularity.